Our Children | A Living Memory Archive

আমাদের শিশু | একটি জীবন্ত স্মৃতি-আর্কাইভ

Who Owns Memory? - Final Submission Wrapper

Participant	Dr Moiyen Zalal Chowdhury
Working mode	Solo
Thematic group	Digital Memory, Democracy, Misinformation & Representation
Final format	Social-media storytelling project
Public project URL	https://www.facebook.com/OurChildrenMemoryBD/

Project description

Our Children is a digital public-memory project examining what happens when a child-related tragedy becomes intensely visible in the social-media public sphere and then gradually recedes from collective attention. The submitted project presents one completed pilot episode within a longer-term living archive. Rather than reproducing victim imagery or creating a catalogue of cases, it follows how a digital public forms around an episode: people share, grieve, speculate, explain, assign responsibility, demand justice, and then move on as new events enter the feed.

The project draws on a digital-ethnographic archive assembled around the Apratim case in Bangladesh in September 2026. The research corpus contains 26 public source items and 12,150 Facebook comments and replies (11,091 main comments and 1,059 replies). Automated coding was used as a preliminary discovery layer; the public-facing project relies on selected material that is checked against source context and presented in anonymised or paraphrased form where necessary.

> **“The feed moves on. Memory should not.”**

Central public-history question

What happens to public memory when the feed moves on?

The project also asks who remains visible after intense digital attention fades, which questions survive the attention cycle, and what responsibilities an archive has when returning to stories involving vulnerable people.

Where and when the story is situated

The story is situated in Bangladesh in September 2026 and is primarily digital. It follows the online public life of one child-related episode as it moved through social media, news reporting and public discussion. Its focus is not only the event itself, but the digital public that formed around it: mourning, blame, justice claims, parenting and childhood discourse, social and moral diagnosis, and wider political or institutional interpretation.

Digital-ethnographic method

Corpus	26 public source items; 12,150 comments and replies
Comment structure	11,091 main comments; 1,059 replies
Initial analysis	Automated/preliminary first-pass coding used to identify possible patterns
Public-history evidence	Selected items checked against source context; ordinary users anonymised; sensitive/searchable comments paraphrased
Epistemic rule	Verified fact, reported allegation/public claim, observation and interpretation are kept separate
Ethical rule	Public visibility is not treated as permission to reproduce harm

Why this story matters

Digital platforms can make tragedy intensely public while making public attention unusually temporary. Posts, reactions, explanations and justice claims accumulate rapidly; another event can then displace them. Visibility is therefore not the same as memory.

The project experiments with a different form of remembrance: preserving questions, public responses and evidentiary context while reducing renewed exposure and representational harm. It treats return - not endless recirculation - as part of responsible public memory.

Narrative logic of the pilot episode

Visibility → Public Reaction → Explanation → Justice Claims → Fading → Return

Main historical and digital sources

1. Digital-ethnography corpus

Apratim Digital Publics research archive: 26 public source items and 12,150 linked comments/replies. Raw identifiers and sensitive material are retained in a restricted research archive; the public project uses anonymised/paraphrased evidence.

2. The Business Standard, 19 Sep 2026

“Comilla University teacher's 13-yr-old son found dead in jungle a day after going missing.” https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/comilla-university-teachers-13-year-old-son-found-dead-jungle-1547096

3. bdnews24.com, 19 Sep 2026

“A schoolboy went out to take photos. He never came home.” https://bdnews24.com/bangladesh/ur01k671cp

4. bdnews24.com, 19 Sep 2026

“How Cumilla schoolboy’s body was found.” https://bdnews24.com/bangladesh/pq3sd5ji3x

5. The Business Standard, 20 Sep 2026

“Apratim murder: Family files case, no accused named.” https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/apratim-murder-family-files-case-no-accused-named-1547926

6. Contemporaneous public notices and source posts

Publicly circulated missing-child notices and social-media posts used to reconstruct the initial phase of digital visibility. Identifying child imagery is not reproduced in the submitted pilot episode.

Source transparency

News reporting is used to establish and cross-check chronology. Social-media comments are treated as evidence of public discourse and participation, not as proof that the claims made by commenters are factually true. Preliminary automated category counts are not presented as definitive findings in the final public-history story.

Rights, ethics and publication

• Minors and family privacy: the submitted pilot episode does not reproduce identifying images of minors, private family photographs or graphic imagery.

• Ordinary social-media users: usernames and personal identifiers are not published; sensitive or readily searchable comments are paraphrased.

• Allegations: allegations and speculation are not presented as established facts. Reported claims are attributed and kept distinct from verified information.

• Rights: the project does not rely on reproducing third-party photographs or video in the submission wrapper. Where external material informs the story, it is cited rather than republished unless there is a clear lawful basis for use.

• Correction principle: if a factual, privacy or rights concern is identified, the project will correct or remove the affected material.

“We remember without reproducing the violation.”

Accessibility

The core project metadata, question and methodological explanation are available in English for the international Who Owns Memory? audience, while Bengali remains central to the Bangladesh-facing archive. Essential information is provided as selectable text rather than only through images. This submission wrapper contains no informative images requiring alt text. Where visual cards are used on the public page, the accompanying post text is intended to carry the essential information.

AI responsibility disclosure

Generative AI was used as an assisted editorial, organisational and translation-support tool during project development. AI output was not treated as historical evidence, did not fabricate quotations, testimonies, archival material or sources, and did not determine source selection or factual status. Historical claims and references were independently reviewed by the author. Sensitive raw research material, private family material and confidential data were not intentionally supplied to public AI services. Final responsibility for interpretation, verification, ethical judgement and publication remains with the author.

Authorship

Author and project lead: Dr Moiyen Zalal Chowdhury. This submission is a solo project. The submitted pilot episode is complete; the wider Our Children archive is designed to remain a living project that may return to stories after public attention has moved elsewhere.